HYC CROSSFIT

THE HYC ZONE FOOD BLOCK GRAM GUIDE

ULTIMATE GRAM EDITION 2026

A precise, scale-ready Zone reference for everyday coaching: gram-based portions, clear block math, label rules and practical foods for real meals.

PROTEIN
7 g
per P block

NET
9 g
per C block

ADDED
1.5 g
with animal protein

WEIGH. BALANCE. REPEAT.

Edible weight, with raw/cooked state stated wherever it matters.

THE SYSTEM IN GRAMS

SCALE-READY

BUILD THE RATIO - THEN WEIGH THE FOOD

A precise Zone reference built for everyday use. Start with the 1:1:1 block structure, weigh the edible portion in the state shown, and use nutrition-label math whenever a packaged or mixed food varies by brand.

1 P BLOCK

7 g protein

Use lean protein as the anchor of the meal.

1 C BLOCK

9 g net carbs

Net carbs = total carbohydrate minus fibre.

1 F BLOCK

1.5 g added fat

Use 3 g when protein is vegetarian or essentially fat-free.

THE 1:1:1 RULE

A 3-block meal = 3 P + 3 C + 3 F. That means about 21 g protein, 27 g net carbohydrate and, in classic Zone counting, 4.5 g added fat when lean animal protein is used.

CORE OPERATING RULES

- **START WITH PROTEIN** — Choose the number of protein blocks first, then match carbohydrate and fat blocks.
- **USE EDIBLE GRAMS** — Weigh the portion you actually eat. Raw and cooked weights are not interchangeable.
- **COUNT NET CARBS** — For label-based foods, use total carbohydrate minus fibre, then divide by 9.
- **RESPECT MIXED FOODS** — Eggs, salmon, cheese, yogurt and similar foods can contribute more than one macro.
- **LET THE LABEL WIN** — For packaged foods, powders, sauces, soups and deli products, the exact nutrition label is the best reference.

HOW TO READ THE ASTERISK

* = a practical gram target derived from an official househportion and/or standard food-composition data when a direct gram value is not listed. Brand, preparation and drained weight can shift the number.

MEAT, EGGS, DAIRY & PLANT PROTEIN

ONE P BLOCK

PROTEIN PORTIONS - ALL IN GRAMS

These are one-protein-block food weights. Whole eggs, cheese, feta and some yogurts are mixed foods: they provide protein but also bring fat and/or carbohydrate.

MEAT / POULTRY	g	ZONE
Chicken breast, skinless	28	BEST
Chicken breast, deli	43	BEST
Turkey breast, skinless	28	BEST
Turkey breast, deli	35	BEST
Turkey, ground lean	35	BEST
Beef, filet mignon	28	FAIR
Beef strip, lean	28	FAIR
Beef ground <10% fat	28	POOR
Ham, lean	28	FAIR
Ham, deli	43	FAIR
Duck breast	35	FAIR
Lamb, lean	35	FAIR
Pork, lean / chop	35	FAIR
Veal, lean	28	FAIR

EGG / DAIRY / PLANT	g	ZONE
Egg whites	66	BEST
Whole egg	50	FAIR
Cottage cheese 1%	60	BEST
Greek yogurt, non-fat	69	BEST
Greek yogurt, low-fat	80*	BEST
Plain yogurt, low-fat	133	BEST
Low-fat cheese	28	FAIR
Mozzarella, part-skim	28	FAIR
Ricotta, skim	57	FAIR
Tofu, firm	71	FAIR
Tofu, soft	85	FAIR
Tofu, silken	156	FAIR
Tempeh	35	FAIR
Soy burger	60	FAIR
Edamame, boiled	55*	FAIR
Feta	50*	MIXED
Parmesan, grated	20*	MIXED

PROTEIN POWDER

Do not use a fixed powder weight. Weigh enough powder to supply 7 g of actual protein from the label. Formula: grams of powder = 700 / protein grams per 100 g. Example: 80 g protein per 100 g -> 8.8 g powder for 1 P block.

FISH & SEAFOOD - SPECIES MATTERS

ONE P BLOCK

FISH & SEAFOOD

The Zone reference does not use one generic fish weight. Protein density varies by species, so bass, cod, salmon, tuna and snapper do not all get the same portion.

FISH / SEAFOOD	g	ZONE
Bass, sea/freshwater	57	BEST
Bluefish	35	BEST
Calamari / squid	43	BEST
Catfish	43	BEST
Clams	43	BEST
Cod	43	BEST
Crab meat	35	BEST
Haddock	43	BEST
Halibut	35	BEST
Lobster	43	BEST
Mackerel	43	BEST

FISH / SEAFOOD	g	ZONE
Salmon	43	BEST
Sardines	43	BEST
Scallops	43	BEST
Shrimp / prawns	28	BEST
Snapper	28	BEST
Swordfish	35	BEST
Trout	28	BEST
Tuna steak	28	BEST
Tuna canned in water	28	BEST
Octopus, cooked	24*	EXTRA

OCTOPUS VS SQUID

Octopus is not listed in the Zone reference table. The 24 g figure is derived from cooked octopus protein density (~29-30 g protein/100 g), so it needs much less weight for 7 g protein than squid. For packaged octopus, the label wins.

RAW VEGETABLES

ONE C BLOCK

RAW VEGETABLES - GRAM EDITION

Leafy and watery vegetables can require very large weights to reach 9 g net carbohydrate. That is normal. In real meals, combine several vegetables instead of forcing one enormous portion.

RAW VEGETABLE	g	ZONE
Broccoli, raw	210	BEST
Brussels sprouts, raw	175	BEST
Cabbage, green raw	280	BEST
Cabbage, red raw	180*	EXTRA
Carrot, grated/raw	132	BEST
Cauliflower, raw	295	BEST
Celery, sliced raw	650	BEST
Cucumber, raw	550	BEST
Bell peppers, raw	240	BEST
Mushrooms, raw	280	BEST

RAW VEGETABLE	g	ZONE
Onion, raw	120	BEST
Radish, raw	460	BEST
Snow peas, raw	123	BEST
Spinach, raw	600	BEST
Tomato, raw	333	BEST
Cherry tomatoes	335	BEST
Romaine lettuce	650	BEST
Arugula / rucola	440*	EXTRA
Green beans, raw	250*	EXTRA
Zucchini, raw	600*	EXTRA

PRACTICAL POINT

100 g of spinach, arugula, lettuce or cucumber is not a full carbohydrate block. These foods are excellent for volume and micronutrients, but their carb contribution is small compared with fruit, legumes, grains or potatoes.

COOKED VEGETABLES & LEGUMES

ONE C BLOCK

COOKED VEGETABLES & LEGUMES

Cooking changes water content and therefore grams per block. Weigh foods in the state shown here. Beans and lentils are much more carbohydrate-dense than broccoli, cauliflower or zucchini.

COOKED FOOD	g	ZONE
Artichoke, cooked	160*	BEST
Asparagus, cooked	400*	BEST
Black beans, cooked	86*	BEST
Green beans, cooked	188*	BEST
Bok choy, cooked	1100*	BEST
Broccoli, cooked	235*	BEST
Brussels sprouts, cooked	195*	BEST
Butternut squash, cooked	100*	FAIR
Cabbage, cooked	250*	BEST
Cauliflower, cooked	500*	BEST
Chickpeas, cooked	41*	BEST
Collard greens, cooked	475*	BEST
Corn, cooked	41*	FAIR
Eggplant, cooked	445*	BEST
Kale, cooked	325*	BEST
Kidney beans, cooked	44*	BEST

COOKED FOOD	g	ZONE
Leek, cooked	130*	BEST
Lentils, cooked	66*	BEST
Mushrooms, cooked	310*	BEST
Onion, cooked	105*	BEST
Parsnip, cooked	67	FAIR
Peas, cooked	120*	FAIR
Pinto beans, cooked	51	FAIR
Potato, baked	45	FAIR
Potato, boiled / baby	50*	FAIR
Sweet potato, baked	50*	FAIR
Sweet potato, mashed	36	FAIR
Zucchini, cooked	495*	BEST
Yellow squash, cooked	315*	BEST
Beetroot, cooked	110*	EXTRA
Pumpkin, cooked	120*	EXTRA

BABY POTATOES

Use the cooked weight. Around 50 g boiled potato = 1 C block in this guide, so 150 g cooked baby potatoes is about 3 C blocks. Preparation and variety can shift the number.

FRUIT

ONE C BLOCK

FRUIT PORTIONS - EDIBLE GRAMS

The guide used halves, whole fruits and cups. Here the same concept is translated into edible grams. The Zone ranking reflects glycemic load within the Zone system, not whether a food is "healthy" or "unhealthy" in general.

FRUIT	g	ZONE
Apple	90*	BEST
Apricots	105*	BEST
Banana	40*	POOR
Blackberries	190*	BEST
Blueberries	75*	BEST
Cantaloupe	122	POOR
Cherries, sweet	65*	BEST
Cranberries, raw	75*	POOR
Fig, fresh	50*	POOR
Grapefruit	120*	BEST
Grapes	75*	BEST
Guava	100	POOR
Honeydew melon	85*	POOR
Kiwi	75*	BEST
Lemon	115*	BEST

FRUIT	g	ZONE
Lime	115	BEST
Mango	55*	POOR
Nectarine	70*	BEST
Orange, small	96	BEST
Mandarin / tangerine	90*	BEST
Papaya	96	POOR
Peach	112	BEST
Pear	74	BEST
Pineapple	75	POOR
Plum	65*	BEST
Prunes, dried	16	POOR
Raisins	9*	POOR
Raspberries	165*	BEST
Strawberries	165*	BEST
Watermelon	122	POOR

BERRY REFERENCE

For practical gram counting in this guide: blueberries are ~75 g per C block and raspberries ~165 g per C block. Berries are fibre-rich, so their usable-carbohydrate density differs substantially by type.

GRAINS, STARCHES & CONCENTRATED CARBS

ONE C BLOCK

GRAINS, STARCHES & EXTRAS

These foods reach 9 g net carbohydrate quickly, so the gram portions are small. In the Zone system most grains/starches are less favourable than non-starchy vegetables and berries.

FOOD	g	ZONE
Barley, dry	10*	BEST
Barley, cooked	40*	BEST
Oatmeal, dry	14	BEST
Oatmeal, cooked	80*	BEST
Bread, white/whole grain	15*	POOR
Breadcrumbs	15*	POOR
Cereal, dry	14	POOR
Cornbread	18	POOR
Couscous, dry	11	POOR
Croissant	15	POOR
Granola	25	POOR
Egg noodles, cooked	35*	POOR
Pasta, cooked	35*	POOR
Popcorn, air-popped	12*	POOR

FOOD	g	ZONE
Rice cake	14	POOR
Brown rice, cooked	40*	POOR
White rice, cooked	32*	POOR
Red rice, cooked	40*	EXTRA
Quinoa, cooked	49*	EXTRA
Corn tortilla	24*	POOR
Waffle	25	POOR
Potato chips	14	POOR
Pretzels	14	POOR
Sugar, granulated	8*	POOR
Honey	11*	POOR
Maple syrup	13*	POOR
Ketchup	34*	POOR
BBQ sauce	34*	POOR

QUINOA & RED RICE

These are not listed in the Zone reference table. Practical values are calculated from standard cooked food composition: quinoa ~49 g per C block; red rice ~40 g per C block. Use package data when available.

OILS, NUTS, SEEDS & SPREADS

ONE F BLOCK

FAT PORTIONS - ALL IN GRAMS

These portions represent one classic added-fat mini-block. With lean animal protein, 1 F block is about 1.5 g added fat. With vegetarian or essentially fat-free protein, double the fat blocks to reach ~3 g total fat per block.

FAT SOURCE	g	ZONE
Olive oil	1.5	BEST
Almond oil	1.5	BEST
Canola oil	1.5	FAIR
Peanut oil	1.5	BEST
Sesame oil	1.5	FAIR
Almonds	3.6*	BEST
Cashews	3.0*	BEST
Macadamia nuts	2.5*	BEST
Peanuts	3.0	BEST
Avocado	15*	BEST
Guacamole	15*	BEST
Natural peanut butter	2.5*	BEST

FAT SOURCE	g	ZONE
Tahini	7.5*	BEST
Walnuts, chopped	2.5*	FAIR
Olives	11	BEST
Mayonnaise, light	5*	FAIR
Mayonnaise, regular	1.7*	FAIR
Butter	1.7*	POOR
Sunflower seeds	3.0*	EXTRA
Pumpkin seeds	3.0*	EXTRA
Hazelnuts	2.5*	EXTRA
Brazil nuts	2.2*	EXTRA
Pecans	2.1*	EXTRA
Pistachios	3.3*	EXTRA

FATTY PROTEINS CHANGE THE MATH

Whole eggs, salmon, mackerel, sardines, feta and hard cheeses already contain meaningful fat. Do not automatically add olive oil or nuts as if the protein were skinless chicken. For strict counting, total the fat from the label first.

WHEN THE FOOD IS MIXED, USE THE LABEL

NO FALSE PRECISION

MIXED FOODS & LABEL MATH

A fixed gram table is only honest for fairly consistent whole foods. Yogurt brands, protein powders, soups, sauces and prepared foods can vary too much; here the label replaces guesswork.

P BLOCKS

protein / 7

Protein grams on the label divided by 7.

C BLOCKS

net carbs / 9

(Total carbohydrate - fibre) divided by 9.

F BLOCKS

fat / 1.5

For added-fat counting with lean animal protein. Use /3 for total-fat vegetarian counting.

MIXED FOODS HYC MEMBERS OFTEN USE

Whole egg, ~50 g	~1 P but ~5 g fat - usually no added fat needed.
Feta, ~50 g*	~1 P but high fat; calculate fat from label.
Parmesan, ~20 g*	~1 P by protein math; also concentrated fat/sodium.
Cottage cheese, ~60 g	~1 P in Zone reference; carbs/fat vary by brand.
Greek yogurt, 69 g non-fat	~1 P; still contains some carbohydrate.
Milk 1%, ~245 g	A mixed protein/carbohydrate food, not pure protein.
Hummus, ~60 g*	Carb + fat + some protein; label math is cleaner.
Protein powder	Weigh enough powder to supply 7 g actual protein.
Vegetable soup	Count potato/pumpkin/cream/oil/sugar from recipe or label.
Salad dressing	Count oil and sugar; vinegar itself contributes little.

THE LABEL OVERRIDES THE TABLE

If the exact product is packaged, use its label. This matters especially for cottage cheese, yogurt, deli meat, protein powders, nut butters, sauces and prepared soups.

THE FOODS YOU USE MOST

SCALE-READY

1-BLOCK AND 3-BLOCK WEIGHTS

This page is designed for the kitchen scale. It turns the most common HYC foods into direct 1-block and 3-block gram targets. Asterisked foods are derived/extra rather than direct Zone gram entries.

FOOD	1 BLK g	3 BLK g	TYPE
Chicken breast	28	84	P
Turkey breast	28	84	P
Cod	43	129	P
Salmon	43	129	P
Sea bass	57	171	P
Snapper	28	84	P
Trout	28	84	P
Tuna	28	84	P
Octopus cooked	24*	72*	P
Cottage cheese 1%	60	180	P
Greek yogurt non-fat	69	207	P
Egg whites	66	198	P
Quinoa cooked	49*	147*	C
Brown/red rice cooked	40*	120*	C
Boiled potato	50*	150*	C

FOOD	1 BLK g	3 BLK g	TYPE
Apple	90*	270*	C
Pear	74	222	C
Kiwi	75*	225*	C
Banana	40*	120*	C
Blueberries	75*	225*	C
Raspberries	165*	495*	C
Carrot raw	132	396	C
Olive oil	1.5	4.5	F
Almonds	3.6*	10.8*	F
Walnuts	2.5*	7.5*	F
Pumpkin seeds	3*	9*	F
Sunflower seeds	3*	9*	F
Avocado	15*	45*	F
Peanut butter	2.5*	7.5*	F

KITCHEN ROUNDING

For day-to-day coaching, rounding 28 g chicken to 30 g is fine; 3 blocks becomes ~90 g. Keep exact numbers when teaching the reference, then use sensible kitchen rounding in practice.

ALL EXAMPLES USE GRAMS

PRACTICAL EXAMPLES

FROM ONE-BLOCK SNACKS TO THREE-BLOCK MEALS

These examples show the structure. They are not the only combinations. With fatty fish, eggs or cheese, reduce or omit added fat because the protein source already contains it.

1-BLOCK SNACK

60 g cottage cheese + 75 g kiwi + 3 g pumpkin seeds

~1 P / 1 C / 1 F. Very close to the snack pattern you use most often.

1-BLOCK SNACK

69 g non-fat Greek yogurt + 75 g blueberries + 3 g sunflower seeds

~1 P / 1 C / 1 F. Check the yogurt label if the brand is not non-fat/plain.

3-BLOCK CHICKEN MEAL

84-90 g chicken + 147 g cooked quinoa + 4.5 g olive oil

~3 P / 3 C / 3 F by block structure. Add leafy vegetables freely for volume.

3-BLOCK COD MEAL

129 g cod + 100 g boiled potato + 74 g pear + 4.5 g olive oil

3 P; potato ~2 C + pear 1 C; 3 added-fat blocks.

3-BLOCK TUNA MEAL

84 g tuna + 120 g cooked red/brown rice + 4.5 g olive oil

~3 P / 3 C / 3 F. Add tomato, cucumber and greens; count them only if portions become large.

3-BLOCK SALMON MEAL

129 g salmon + 120 g cooked red rice + vegetables

Protein and carbs are near 3 blocks, but salmon already carries substantial fat - do not automatically add 4.5 g oil.

3-BLOCK SHAKE

Protein powder providing 21 g protein + 120 g banana + 10.8 g almonds

~3 P / 3 C / 3 F using block targets; verify powder label.

PRECISION, CONSISTENCY & SOURCES

FINAL PAGE

THE ULTIMATE ZONE CHECKLIST

Use this page when a meal is unclear. The goal is not obsessive precision - it is a repeatable system that stays consistent across foods, brands and cooking methods.

1. **MATCH THE BLOCKS**
   Build meals and snacks around equal numbers of P, C and F blocks.
2. **PROTEIN**
   1 P block = 7 g protein. Choose your P blocks first.
3. **CARBOHYDRATE**
   1 C block = 9 g net carbohydrate. Net carbs = total carbs minus fibre.
4. **FAT**
   1 F block = ~1.5 g added fat with lean animal protein; use ~3 g when the protein source is essentially fat-free/vegetarian.
5. **WEIGH THE RIGHT STATE**
   Raw and cooked weights can differ substantially. Use the state written in the table.
6. **COUNT MIXED FOODS**
   Eggs, salmon, cheese, yogurt, hummus and sauces can contribute more than one macro.
7. **REDUCE ADDED FAT WHEN NEEDED**
   Fatty fish, whole eggs and cheese may already cover part or all of the fat requirement.
8. **USE THE LABEL**
   For packaged foods, the exact label overrides a generic table.
9. **ROUND FOR REAL LIFE**
   Teach the reference accurately, then use sensible kitchen rounding for day-to-day consistency.

SOURCES & METHOD

- **ZONE LIVING / ZONE LABS** — Zone Food Blocks reference used for the core block definitions and listed food portions.
- **USDA FOODDATA CENTRAL** — Used for standard food-composition checks and selected gram conversions/additions not directly listed in Zone tables.
- **METHOD** — Ounce values are converted to grams and rounded for kitchen use. Housemeasures are translated to edible gram weights. Derived additions are marked *.
- **PRECISION RULE** — Food composition changes with cultivar, ripeness, cooking, drained weight and brand. For packaged or mixed foods, use the nutrition label.
- **SCOPE** — Educational coaching reference only. It is a Zone block guide, not medical advice and not a claim that one food ranking fits every dietary context.